

SImulating online deBAtes (SIMBA)

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Abstract

Choices regarding what we eat have a profound impact on the world around us, for example on our health (Springmann et al., 2016; Forouzanfar et al., 2015) and the environment (Garnett., 2008; Vermeulen et al., 2012). Notably, the food system accounts for more than a quarter of greenhouse gas emissions (GHG), where 80% of these emissions are attributed to livestock production (Steinfeld et al., 2006). Reducing these emissions to meet national (European Commission., 2024) and international commitments (OECD, 2025) implies reducing red meat consumption and broader diet change (Rockström et al., 2025; Schebesta & Candel., 2020).

This study has the goal of investigating how to encourage behavioral change and uncovering the mechanisms underlying this change. It uses data collected by Dheilly et al. (unpublished) who developed a cluster-randomized study using group deliberation to better understand how information is diffused in a social setting related to meat consumption reduction. It implements models of social influence inspired by Flache et al. (2017) and an argumentation model following the work of Taillandier et al. (2021) in GAMA to try and understand the empirical behavior of agents in the deliberation study.

Additional material

Not sure if I should link to the github repository with my code.

In any case I reference the OSF registration.
OSF Protocol